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Fate's Edge

largeEssential Starting Guide

2.2 Difficulty Value (DV)

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largeGM Player Reference One Region, One Road

tshape “The road remembers. Every broken wheel
leaves a mark, every lit lamp bears witness. The
only question is: what are you willing to owe?” fill
Dusana of the Raven Road

Welcome to Fate's Edge. This guide contains everything
you need to start playingcore rules, character creation, one
region (Acasia), GM procedures, and a starter adventure
hook. No other books required.

large1 The Philosophy of Consequence

1.1 Narrative First

Every roll tells a story. In Fate's Edge, mechanics serve
the story. When you roll dice, you are not asking “did I
succeed?”you are asking “what happens next?”

The Golden Rule: When in doubt, make the choice that
serves the story. Set DV=3, Position=Controlled, and let
the dice fall.

1.2 Safety at the Table

Fate's Edge explores mature themes. Use these tools to keep
play safe:

tem **XCard:** Any player may say “X” to stop a scene.
No questions asked. tem **Lines:** Content that will
not appear (e.g., “no harm to children”). tem **Veils:**
Content that fades to black (e.g., “romance is implied,
not described”).

Establish these in Session Zero.

large2 The Core Resolution

2.1 The 90Second Loop

tshape Every choice carries weight

Every meaningful action follows this cycle:

DVs to “challenge” playersuse Position instead.

2.3 Position

Position tells you how risky the action is and changes how

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Pro tip: Spend 1

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2.4 The Outcome Matrix

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A Partial is not failure. It moves the story forward: improve Position for next attempt, reduce DV, succeed at reduced scale, or reveal information.

A Miss is never “nothing happens.” The GM must introduce a complication.

2.5 Critical Success (10s)

A roll of 10 counts as **two successes**. If the overall roll succeeds:

tem **1 ten**: Strong successimprove Position or gain
minor advantage. tem **2 tens**: Exceptionalchoose two
benefits. tem **3+ tens**: Legendarydecisive victory; clear
1 segment from a relevant timer.

large3 Resources: Boons Story Beats

3.1 BoonsPlayer Currency

Boons represent luck, momentum, and narrative leverage.

Spend them freely. [Boons at a Glance]

cap: 5 Boons. At end of scene, reduce to 2 (excess lost).

The Math of Fun: Hoarding Boons for XP conversion starves the table of drama. A rerolled failure or an improved Position creates a memorable moment. Spend Boons!

3.2 Story Beats (SB)GM Currency

Every time a player rolls a 1, the GM gains Story Beats. Spend SB to introduce complications: [SB Spend Menu]

Complication	Effect
Minor	Position
1 noise, distraction, tick a timer +1	1 worsens one step
2 Moderate	2 If ready
3 Alarm raised, lose advantage	Desperate, 1 die; otherwise Position
4 Major	Recovery: Short rest removes 2 Fatigue; worsens
5 Re-inforcements, scene shifts, break an asset	3 dice (if already ready Desperate from Fatigue)
6	4 Collapse, KO, incapacitated
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large4 Injury Exhaustion

4.1 FatigueThe Weight of the World

Each point of Fatigue worsens your Position. If already Desperate, each Fatigue imposes 1 die instead. [Fatigue

4.2 HarmSerious Injury

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4.3 The RollerCoaster Effect

Taking Harm clears Fatigue. The shock of a wound resets your exhaustion. This creates dramatic swings a character near collapse who takes a wound and finds a second wind.

4.4 Armor Conversion

When you take Harm, armor converts some to Fatigue: [Ar-

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large5 Building Your Character

5.1 10Minute Checklist

Start with **32 XP** (max 36 with Bonds/Complications).

tem **Concept:** One sentence (origin, profession, defining trait). tem **Attributes (15):** Spend XP_{primary} to 3 (9 XP), secondaries to 2 (6 XP each). tem **Skills (05):** Spend 812 XP on key skills. tem **Talents:** 13 talents (26 XP each). tem **Patron (optional):** Choose a Patron for magic. tem **Assets/Followers (optional):** Minor Asset (4 XP) or follower (Cap² XP). tem **Bonds Complications:** Up to +4 XP total.

5.2 Attributes

[illegible]

5.3 Skills

Cost to raise: New level 2 XP. Downtime = new level in
line with the **Physical**
Combat
line with the **Stratics**
Melee
line with the **Religion**
line with the **Endurance**
days. [Core Skills] line with the **Performance**
line with the **Insight**
line with the **Knowledge**
line with the **Arcana**
line with the **Investigation**
line with the **Medicine**
line with the **rule**

5.4 Sample Starting BuildThe Duelist (32 XP)

tem **Attributes:** Body 3 (15 XP), Wits 2 (6 XP) tem
Skills: Melee 2 (6 XP), Athletics 1 (2 XP) tem **Talent:**
Keen Senses (2 XP) tem **Total:** 31 XP (bank 1)

large6 The Known World: Acasia

“The Broken Province”

6.1 Genre Mood

Low fantasy / mercenary realism / border feud. Aca-
sia festers between the fallen Utaran Empire and the am-
bitions of petty kings. Every bridge demands a price, and
every road curves back to the same cursed crossroads.

6.2 What You Notice First

The smell of mildew on old parchment and wet ash. The way
every milestone has been recarved. The silence of a village
that heard you coming and chose not to open its gates.

6.3 The One Rule That Kills Newcomers

Never sign a contract on a bridge. The river is a witness,
and it never forgets a signature.

6.4 Key Factions

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6.5 The Curse of Acasia

The land remembers what we didand what we failed to do.
Every broken milestone is a forgotten promise. **Mechanical
effect:** When you cross a bridge or crossroads, roll Spirit +
Resolve (DV 3). On a failure, the Curse stirsgain 1 Fatigue
or a minor complication (GM’s choice).

6.6 Acasia MiniGenerator (d6)

tem A bridge toll has tripled overnight; the tollkeeper is a
deserter from your old company. tem A hedgewitch offers
to break your blooddebtfor the memory of your first kill.
tem The Lame King travels with a mute jester who writes
prophecies on fallen leaves. tem Bandits stole a Blackwood
Matriarch’s cursebox. Recover it before it opens. tem
A free company captain wants to hire youbut their last
three hires died of “accidents.” tem The Margravine’s
seal is missing. Whoever finds it can rewrite border law.

large7 Running Fate’s Edge

7.1 The GM Mindset

You are not a referee. You are a **cocreator of drama**. Your
tools (SB, timers) are how you play the game.

sectionScene 4Escape (Skill Challenge) The party needs **3 successes before 2 failures** to escape. DV 3, Position Desperate. Each failure ticks Barrow Collapse +1.

8.5 Resolution

Return the lantern to the stone circle. Break the curse with Spirit + Lore (DV 2). **Partial:** Curse lifts, but the lantern attracts another danger soon.

8.6 Advancement

Each PC earns **610 XP** at the end.

large9 Basic Magic

9.1 The Five Paths (Quick Reference)

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 play a Runkeeper.

9.2 RunkeeperThe Reliable Path

Requirements: Familiar (Thiasos, 2 XP) + Codex (4 XP) + Patron.

Invoking a Rite: 1 action. Mark +1 Obligation. Effect works as written.

Push It: Once per scene, mark +1 Obligation to amplify (+1 die or +1 Effect).

Obligation Capacity: Spirit + Presence. Exceeding capacity = 1 Fatigue per segment.

9.3 SampleThe Traveler's Runkeeper

Kestra, Traveler's Runkeeper (36XP)

tem Spirit 3 (9 XP), Wits 2 (6 XP) tem Lore 2 (6 XP), Insight 1 (2 XP), Sway 1 (2 XP) tem Talents: Familiar (2 XP), Codex (4 XP) tem Rites: RoadSense (4 XP), Traveler's Boon (5 XP) tem Obligation Capacity: 4 (Spirit 3 + Presence 1)

9.4 Free CastingThe TAGS System

For improvisational magic, construct spells using TAGS:

DV = 1 + number of TAGS

Dangerous TAGS (Leap, Fold, Gate, Transform, Dominate)
add +2 DV.

sectionExample Spells

tem **Light** [ILLUMINATE] DV 2. Create small, sustained light. tem **HEAL** [HEAL] DV 2. Remove 1 Fatigue from self or touched ally. tem **Shield of Air** [WARD] [DEFEND] DV 3. Gain Position +1 on next defense. tem **Flame Cloak** [BURNING] [AREA] DV 3. Enemies suffer 1 die to approach.

Backlash: On a Miss or when GM spends SB, magic backfires Fatigue 1, Harm 1, or a thematic complication.

large10 Advancement XP

10.1 Earning XP (Per Session)

[XP Breakdown]

	XP
Achievement	12
Attendance	24
Major objectives	46
Game pace options:	
Disseries	12
Flair	12
choices	13
Story	13
engagement	12
Personal goals	12
tomrule	

XP/session), Standard (610), Epic (1014).

